H-B-1050A
January 18, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. H-B-001050(GSA-FSS)
August 17, 1966
Fed. Spec. H-B-173 (IN PART)
October 8, 1948 (See 6.2)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRUSH, BOTTLE AND BURETTE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers brushes intended for use in cleaning laboratory glassware such as bottles, burettes, beakers and cylinders.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Styles, classes and models. The brushes covered by this specification shall be of the following styles, classes and models as specified (see 6.1).

Style A - Double tuft end
  Class 1 - Hog bristle

    Model W - Wooden handle
    Model P - Plastic handle

Style B - Tufted tip
  Class 1 - Hog bristles
  Class 2 - Synthetic filaments

    Model TW - Twisted wire handle

Style C - Conical single fan tip end
  Class 1 - Hog bristle

    Model W - Wooden handle
    Model TW - Twisted wire handle

  Class 2 - Synthetic filaments

    Model W - Wooden handle
    Model P - Plastic handle
    Model TW - Twisted wire handle

Style D - Single fan tip end
  Class 1 - Hog bristle
  Class 2 - Synthetic filaments
  Class 3 - Horsehair

    Model W - Wooden handle
    Model P - Plastic handle
    Model TW - Twisted wire handle

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of solicitation for offers or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

H-S-951 - Synthetic Filaments For Brushes; General Spefications For.
R-N-91 - Naphthalene, Technical.
PPP-B-1729 - Brushes, Packaging and Packing of.

FSC 7920

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Office in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-W-6110 - Wood; Determination of Moisture Content of.

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications: The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 S. Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Bristle, Class 1. The bristle shall be natural color, stiff, resilient hog bristles of uniform length, and shall be cleaned and sterilized as specified in 3.3. The bristles shall be trimmed so as to show no tendency to separate at the ends.

3.1.2 Synthetic filament, Class 2. The filament for Class 2 brushes shall be made of synthetic polymeric amide, meeting the requirements of Class N, type II of H-S-951. The filament size designation for the respective brushes shall be as specified in 3.2.2.2. The filaments shall be black or white in color as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.1).

3.1.3 Horsehair, Class 3. Horsehair shall be straight and resilient, stiff, black natural color horsehair and shall be cleaned and sterilized as specified in 3.3.

3.1.4 Wire. Wire shall be brass or shall be zinc-coated (galvanized) steel brush wire.

3.1.5 Wood. Wood shall be a close-grained and straight grained hard wood, thoroughly and uniformly dried to a moisture content of not less than 8 and not more than 12 percent at time of manufacture when tested as specified in 4.2.

3.1.6 Plastic. Plastic shall be of any type which will not soften or be materially affected by hot water or cleaning agents.

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3.2 Construction. The brushes shall be of the general designs illustrated in figures 1-4.

3.2.1 Style A, Class 1. The bristles in style A brushes shall be secured within two loops of twisted wires having four ends firmly attached to a plastic or wooden handle. The bristles shall be approximately parallel to each other and at an angle of approximately 90° to the wire. The bristles shall be evenly distributed in the brush head.

3.2.1.1 Tufts. Two stiff but resilient bristle tufts shall be attached at the end of the brush head. The tufts shall be neatly and securely bound near their bases with wire and shall extend at least 3/8 inch beyond the end of the bristle in the brush. (See figure 1.)

3.2.1.2 Handles.

3.2.1.2.1 Model W. Model W handles shall be made of wood, round in shape and shall be not less than 1/2 inch in diameter. The handle shall have a hole approximately 3/16 inch in diameter, centrally located about 3/4 inch from the handle end for hanging the brush. The handles shall be smoothly sanded with corners rounded and finished in accordance with standard commercial practice.

3.2.1.2.2 Model P. The solid plastic handle shall be round or rectangular, and shaped to fit the hand. If rectangular in shape, all edges shall be rounded so as not to cut or injure the hand. Round handles shall have a minimum diameter of 1/2 inch, with a hole at the hand end not less than 3/16 inch in any dimension for hanging the brush. Rectangular handles shall have a minimum dimension of 1/4 inch within the area ordinarily held in the hand when the brush is in use.

3.2.1.3 Dimensions. The dimensions of the parts of style A brushes shall conform to the requirements in table I.

TABLE I. Dimensions of Style A brushes

Length, over-all, minimum	inches	16-1/2
Brush head:		
Length, including tufts, minimum	do	5
Width	do	2-3/4 ± 1/4
Bristle:		
Length, minimum	do	1-1/2 ± 1/8
Handle:		
Length, minimum	do	11-1/2
Diameter, minimum	inch	1/2
Wire (twisted):		
Diameter, single strand, minimum	do	0.0605

3.2.2 Style B, Class 1 and 2. The bristles or filaments in style B brushes shall be secured within twisted wires which shall also form the handle of the brush. The hand end shall have a loop. The bristles or filaments shall be approximately parallel to each other and at an angle of approximately 90° to the wire. The bristles or filaments shall be evenly distributed in the brush head. (See figure 2.)

3.2.2.1 Tuft. Class 1 bristle brushes and class 2 filament brushes shall each have a neatly trimmed tuft of bristle or filament, respectively, extending not less than 3/4 inch beyond the brush end. The tuft shall be neatly and securely bound with wire and shall be located so that the wire will not contact the container being cleaned.

3.2.2.2 Synthetic filament. The size designation of the synthetic filament in style B, class 2 brushes shall be as follows:

Brush size, diameter inch	Filament size designation inch
3/8 and 1/2	0.006
3/4, 1 and 1-1/4	.008
1-1/2	.010
2, and 2-1/2	.014

3.2.2.3 Dimensions. The dimensions of the parts of style B brushes shall conform to the requirements on table II.

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TABLE II. Dimensions of Style B brushes

Characteristics	Size, inches diameter							
Style B, Classes 1 and 2	3/8	1/2	3/4	1	1-1/4	1-1/2	2	2-1/2
Length, overall, minimum inches	21	36	36	16	20	12	16	22
Brush head:								
Length, minimum (exclusive of tuft) inches	3	3-1/2	4	4	4	4-1/2	4-1/2	4-1/2
Diameter ± 1/16, inches	3/8	1/2	3/4	1	1-1/4	1-1/2	2	2-1/2
Wire (twisted):								
Diameter, single strand, minimum, inch	0.0605	0.0605	0.0605	0.0605	0.078	0.078	0.0895	0.0895

3.2.3 Style C.

3.2.3.1 Classes 1 and 2, Model W. The bristles or filaments shall be secured within twisted wires. One end of the twisted wire containing the bristles or filaments shall be securely fastened to a flat metal strip (see 3.2.3.5) and the wire loops over one end of the strip so that the end of the strip will remain in contact with the rwisted wire. The other end of the twisted wire shall be securely fastened to the strip at a distance of approximately 3/4 inch from where the first end was secured. The wire may be fastened to the strip by passing the end through a hole in the strip and bending the wire. The other end of the strip shall be securely set in a wood handle. The bristles or filaments shall be approximately 90° to the wire, shall be evenly distributed in the brush head, and shall be trimmed to give the brush head a conical shape. (See figure 3.)

3.2.3.2 Class 2, Model P. The synthetic filament in the brush head shall be secured within two twisted wires, one end of which shall extend approximately 3 inches above the brush head and be securely inserted into a solid plastic handle. The other end of the twisted wires shall be bent back upon itself to prevent any untwisting. The filaments in the brush head shall be approximately parallel to each other and at an angle of approximately 90° to the wire. The filament shall be evenly distributed in the brush head. The filaments shall be trimmed to give the brush head a conical shape. (See figure 3.)

3.2.3.3 Class 1 and 2, Model TW. The bristles or filaments in Model TW brushes shall be secured within twisted wires which shall also form the handle of the brush. The hand end shall have a loop. The length of the handle including the loop shall be not less than 7 inches. The bristles or filaments shall be approximately parallel to each other and at an angle of approximately 90° to the wire. The bristles or filaments shall be evenly distributed to the brush head and shall be trimmed to give the brush head a conical shape. (See figure 3.)

3.2.3.4 Fan tip end. The lower end of the brush head shall have a fan shaped tip composed of bristles or synthetic filaments evenly distributed and securely bound into the twisted wire. The fan tip shall extend at least one inch beyond the end of the brush head and at least 1/2 inch beyond the end of the bristles or filaments on the sides of the brush head. The fan tip shall be located so that the wire will not contact the container being cleaned.

3.2.3.5 Metal strip. The metal strip for style C brushes having wood handles (3.2.3.1) shall be brass, or shall be steel made corrosion resistant by zinc or other suitable coating. The strip shall have rounded edges and shall be not less than 0.31 inch in width and not less than 0.09 inch in thickness. The strip shall be securely set into the wood handle in accordance with commercial practice.

3.2.3.6 Ferrule. The metal ferrule shall be corrosion-resistant, approximately 5/8 inch wide clamped around the handle where the strip is inserted into the wooded handle.

3.2.3.7 Wood handle. The wooden handles for styles C brushes shall be rounded and shaped to fit the hand. The handle shall have a length of not less than 4 inches and a diameter of not less than 3/4 inch. There shall be a hole approximately 3/16 inch in diameter centrally located about 3/4 inch from the hand end of the brush for hanging the brush.

3.2.3.8 Plastic handle. The solid plastic handles for style C brushes shall be round or rectangular, and shall be shaped to fit the hand. If rectangular in shape, all edges shall be rounded so as not to cut or injure the hand. Round handles shall have a minimum diameter of 3/4 inch, with a hole at the hand end not less than 3/16 inch in any dimension for hanging the brush. Rectangular handles shall have a minimum dimension of 1/4 inch within the area ordinarily held in the hand when the brush is in use. The length of the plastic handle shall be not less than 4 inches and shall have an opening at the hand end for hanging the brush.

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3.2.3.9 Dimensions. The dimensions of the parts of style C brushes shall conform to the requirements of table III.

TABLE III. Dimensions of Style C brushes

Characteristics	Model W	Model P	Model TW
Length, overall minimum, inches	12-1/2	12-1/2	12
Brush head:			
Length including fan tip, minimum inches	5-1/2	5-1/2	5
Diameter at top, minimum, inches	2-1/2	2-1/2	2-3/4
Diameter at bottom, minimum, inches	1-1/2	1-1/2	1-3/4
Wire (twisted):			
Diameter, single strand, minimum, inch	0.0605	0.104	0.104
Filament:			
Size designation	0.012	0.014	0.014

3.2.4 Style D, classes 1, 2, and 3.

3.2.4.1 Models W, P, and TW. The bristles, or filaments or horsehair of style D brushes shall be secured within twisted wires. For models W and P brushes, one end of the twisted wire shall extend 11 ± 1/2 inches above the brush head and be securely inserted into a solid plastic or wooden handle. For model TW brushes one end of the twisted wire shall form the handle and the hand end shall have a loop. The bristles or filaments or horsehair shall be evenly distributed, at an angle approximately 90° to the wire. The lower end of the brush part shall have a fan shaped tip composed of the brush head material neatly and securely bound into the twisted wire. The fan shall extend at least 1/2 inches beyond the ends of the bristles, or filaments or horsehair of the brush head. The fan tip shall be located so that the wire will not come in contact with the containers being cleaned. (See figure 4.)

3.2.4.2 Handles, models W and P. The wooden or solid plastic handles for style D brushes shall be round in shape, 5/8 inch in diameter, and not less than 5 inches long. The handle shall have a hole at the hand end not less than 3/16 inch in any dimension for hanging the brush.

3.2.4.3 Synthetic filament. The size designation of the synthetic filament for class 2 brushes shall be as follows:

Brush size, diameter	Filament size designation
7/8 and 1-1/4	.008
1-1/2 and 1-3/4	.010
2 and 2-1/4	.012

3.2.4.4 Dimensions. The dimensions of the parts of style D brushes shall conform to the requirements in table IV.

TABLE IV. Dimensions of Style D brushes

Characteristics	Size, inches diameter					
(Model TW, Classes 1 and 2)	1/2	7/8	1-1/4	1-3/4	2	2-1/4
Length, overall, minimum, inches	30	36	36	11-1/2	13	22-1/2
Brush head:						
Length, minimum, inches	3	4	4	4-1/2	5	5
Diameter, ± 1/16 inches	1/2	7/8	1-1/4	1-3/4	2	2-1/4
Wire (Twisted):						
Diameter, single strand, minimum, inch	0.0605	0.0605	0.078	0.078	0.078	0.078
(Models W and P, Classes 1, 2, and 3)						
Length overall, minimum, inches	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	22-1/2

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TABLE IV. Dimensions of Style D brushes (con.)

Characteristics	Size, inches diameter					
	1/2	7/8	1-1/4	1-3/4	2	2-1/2
Brush head:						
Length, minimu, inch:						
Classes 1 and 2	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	4-3/4
Class 3	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	6-1/2
Diameter, ± 1/16 inches	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	2-1/4
Wire, (twisted) diameter, single strand, minimum, inch	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	0.078

3.2.5 Illustration. The illustrations shown herein (figures 1 - 4) are for the purpose of identification and are not intended to preclude any brush which otherwise meets the requirements of this specification.

3.3 Sterilization. Horsehair and hog bristle shall be sterilized at some point in the manufacturing process, after thorough washing and rinsing, in accordance with any one of the procedures specified in 3.3.1, 3.3.2, or 3.3.3. A properly checked steam-pressure gauge (applicable for the method in 3.3.3) and a thermometer (for all methods) both visible from the outside of the chambers shall be provided with a suitable recording device to provide a record of the pressure, when applicable, and temperature of the sterilization chamber.

3.3.1 Boiling water. Hog bristles and horsehair shall be soaked in boiling water (212°F.) for not less than 30 minutes.

3.3.2 Dry heat. Hog bristle and horsehair shall be placed in a chamber and a temperature above 284°F. shall be developed and maintained for not less than 3 hours.

3.3.3 Autoclaving. Horsehair and hog bristle shall be placed in a pressure chamber for a minimum of 20 minutes at not less than 15 pounds pressure per square inch at a temperature not less than 248°F. for a minimum of 20 minutes.

3.4 Workmanship. The finished brushes shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects, shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in Standard MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified, or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.2 In process inspection.

4.2.2.1 Moisture content of handles (wood). The handle shall be tested for moisture content prior to being machine and finished in accordance with MIL-W-6110 to determine compliance with 3.3.5. The sample unit shall be one handle. The lot shall be the number of handles being manufactured under essentially the same conditions and to be offered for inspection at one time. Three determinations shall be taken on each sample unit and the results shall be the average of three determinations. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality (AQL) of 2.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.2.3 End item inspection.

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4.2.3.1 Examination of the end item. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the classification of defects, inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) set forth below. The lot size, for the purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105, shall be expressed in units of brushes for examinations under 4.2.3.1.1 and 4.2.3.1.2, in units of intermediate containers for examination under 4.2.3.1.3 and in units of shipping containers for examination under 4.2.3.1.4.

4.2.3.1.1 Examination of the end item for defects in appearance, construction and workmanship. The sample unit for this examination shall be one brush of each class, style and model.

Examine	Defects
Material	Bristle not natural hog; not stiff and resilient. Synthetic filament not as specified. Horsehair not stiff and resilient; not natural horsehair. Wire not brass or zinc-coated (galvanized) steel brush wire. Wood handle (when applicable) not made of a close, straight grained hardwood.
Construction and apperance: Bristles or horsehair (when applicable)	Not uniformly and firmly held in place; can be removed by hand. Not evenly distributed in brush head; not uniform in length, trimmed so as to separate at ends. Not of a natural color.
Synthetic filament (when applicable)	Not black or white (natural) when specified; not uniformly and firmly held in place; can be removed by hand; not evenly distributed in brush head, size of filament not as specified.
Brush head: (when applicable)	Not constructed as shown for applicable style shown in figures 1-4. Not provided with two tufts extending beyond brush head; tuft not securely bound with wire. Not provided with a neatly trimmed tuft extending beyond brush heads; tuft not securely bound with wire. Not conical shape; not provided with neatly trimmed fan shape end or fan not extending beyond the end of brush as specified. Bristles, filaments or horsehair not secured within twisted wires. Bristles not secured within two loops of twisted wires having four ends firmly attached to a wooden handle. Bristles not perpendicular to wire or handle.
Brush end (fan or tuft)	Bristles, synthetic filament or horsehair not located in center of length of wire.
Handle (when applicable)	Not specified shape or shaped to fit hand. Not provided with a hole in the dimension specificed at hand end for hanging brush. Hand end not provided with loop. Ferrule missing or not as specified.
Workmanship	Bristles, filaments or horsehair not neatly and evenly trimmed; not shaped as specified in figures 1-4. Wood handle not smoothly finished in accordance with commercial practice. Plastic handle not free from sharp edges, mold fins. Sharp edge or point on wire; plating rough or has bare spots.

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4.2.3.1.2 Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one brush.

Examine	Defect
Dimensions	Any dimension not in accordance with specification requirements for model, style, and size brush specified (see tables I through IV).

4.2.3.1.3 Examination of the end item for count. The sample unit for this examination shall be one intermediate container. The average count per container shall be not less than the specified or indicated quantity.

4.2.3.1.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine the packaging, packing and marking requirements, as specified, are complied with. The sample unit for this examination shall be on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery.

Examine	Defect
Packaging	Not packages as specified; intermediate container not as specified.
Packing	Not type shipping container specified. Any break, tear, hole or other defect in container which might cause damage to or loss of content. Waterproof case liner, when applicable, missing or not as specified.
Content	More or less than quantity of units or intermediate containers indicated or specified.
Marking	Omitted, incomplete, incorrect, illegible; not in accordance with contract requirements.

4.2.3.1.5 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) for examination.

Examination paragraph	Inspection level	AQL
4.2.3.1.1	I	4.0
4.2.3.1.2	S-1	2.5
4.2.3.1.3	S-2	---
4.2.3.1.4	S-2	4.0

4.2.4 Testing of end item. The end item shall be tested for the applicable characteristics as specified in 4.3. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 Synthetic filaments. Filaments from Class 2 brushes shall be tested as described in H-S-951.

4.3.1.1 The filament in Class 2 brushes shall be tested for specific gravity, loss in weight, moisture absorption, solvent resistance, resistance to hydrochloric acid, and resistance to normal butanol of the synthetic filament as required in 4.4.1, by taking an equal weight of filament from each brush in the sample for test and thoroughly mixing the filaments.

4.3.2 Diameter of wire. The diameter of the wire taken from the brushes shall be determined by means of a micrometer caliper graduated to read to 0.001 inch or less. Any unevenness in the wire shall be removed before measuring with the micrometer.

4.3.3 Length of bristle, filament or horsehair. The length of the bristle, filament or horsehair shall be determined by means of a scale or tape graduated in 1/16 inches or less.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging and packing. Packaging and packing shall be in accordance with the requirements of PPP-B-1729 as specified for the applicable levels (see 6.1).

5.2 Marking. Containers of the brushes shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of PPP-B-1729.

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Figure 1 - Style A



Figure 3 - Style C
Model W - Wood handle (shown)
Model P - Plastic handle
Model TW- Twisted wire handle



Figure 2 - Style B



Figure 4 - Style D
Model TW - Twisted wire handle
Model W - Wood handle
Model P - Plastic handle

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Style, class, and model of brush required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Size of brush required (see tables I, II, III and IV).
(d) Color of filament for Class 2 brushes (see 3.1.2).
(e) Selection of the applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 Comparison. Comparison of classifications between Federal Specifications H-B-173 and H-B-1050A (GSA-FSS) covering brushes, bottle and burette, is as follows:

H-B-173 1/	H-B-001050
Type I	Style A, Class 1, Model W
None	Style A, Class 1, Model P (New)
Type II	Style B, Class 1, Model TW
None	Style B, Class 2, Model TW (New)
Type III	Style C, Class 1, Model W
None	Style C, Class 1, Model TW (New)
None	Style C, Class 2, Models W, P, and TW (New)
None	Style D, Classes 1, 2, and 3, Models W, P, and TW (New)

1/ Types IV, V, VI and VII brushes presently included in Fed. Spec. H-B-173 and Amendments will be covered by separate Federal Specifications.

6.3 Supersession. That part of Federal Specification H-B-173, that pertains to types I, II, III, superseded by this Federal Specification. The remainder of H-B-173 will remain in force until Federal Specification H-B-1049 and H-B-1051A are published with appropriate supersession data, at which time a cancellation will be published for H-B-173.

MILITARY INTEREST:

DOD has waived coordination in revisions and amendments to this Federal Specification until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA

User Activites:

Navy - MC, SA
Air Force - 84
Army - GL

☆U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE : 1973 O - 514-177 (336)

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